

UX Comparison Report

Manufacturing Cloud Forecasting & Planning vs. Market Competitors

A focused analysis comparing user experience across our solution and leading enterprise planning tools

Prepared: January 30, 2026

Focus: User Experience & Interface Design

Competitors: Pigment, Anaplan, SAP, Oracle, Workday

Executive Summary

Key Finding: Our Manufacturing Cloud Forecasting & Planning solution demonstrates strong UX fundamentals with modern design patterns, scoring 8.0/10 overall. We excel in Salesforce ecosystem integration and collaboration features, but face strong competition from Pigment (9.0/10) in the "modern UX" category.



UX Dimension Scores

UX Dimension	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle	Workday
Visual Design	8.0	9.5	7.0	5.0	5.5	7.5
Grid Interaction	8.5	9.0	8.0	6.0	6.5	7.0
Navigation	8.0	8.5	7.0	5.0	5.0	7.5
Collaboration UX	8.5	9.0	6.5	4.5	5.0	7.0
Learning Curve	8.5	9.0	6.0	4.0	4.0	8.0
OVERALL UX SCORE	8.3	9.0	6.9	4.9	5.2	7.5

Visual Showcase: Our Solution

1. Full Grid View

Search...

Manufacturing Cloud

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

Search in Grid..

Measures / Dimensions x Time	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov
▼ Sales Agreement Quantity	800	720	800	825	800	780	800	740	810	815	800
▼ MagnaDrive - Michigan Plant	800	720	800	825	800	780	800	740	810	815	800
▼ Transmission Assembly	400	400	400	425	400	380	400	400	410	415	400
TRN 750 - A	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - B	80	80	80	105	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - C	95	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	95	80
TRN 750 - D	65	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - E	80	80	80	80	80	60	80	80	90	80	80
> Chassis Components	400	320	400	400	400	400	400	340	400	400	400
> Sales Agreement Revenue	\$80,000	\$70,500	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$78,800	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$75,000
> Opportunity Quantity	1,200	1,200	1,230	1,140	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,280
> Opportunity Revenue	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$112,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$115,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000
> Order Quantity	950	950	950	950	950	950	950	950	950	950	950
> Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
> Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
> Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Clean, modern grid layout with Salesforce Lightning Design System integration. Features hierarchical row expansion, time-based columns, and clear visual hierarchy.

UX Advantages:

- **Clean Layout:** Uncluttered interface with clear visual hierarchy
- **Modern Typography:** Consistent font sizing and spacing
- **Light Background:** Easy on the eyes for long working sessions

- **Hierarchical Structure:** Clear parent-child relationships with expand/collapse

2. Modern Button Group Toolbar



Pill-shaped button group with clear iconography and active state indicators. Blue icons on white background, reversing when active.

Our Solution

- Pill-shaped container with rounded ends
- Blue icons (#0176d3) on white
- Active state reverses colors
- Consistent 32px button size
- Dividers between buttons

Competitors

- **Pigment:** Similar modern approach, custom icons
- **Anaplan:** Individual buttons, less cohesive
- **SAP:** Fiori icon bar, dated look
- **Oracle:** Ribbon-style toolbar, complex

3. Settings Panel (Slide-out)

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

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Search in Grid..

Table Settings

Layout

Select Layout

Measures / Dimensions x Time

Measure, Dimension & Time Settings

Measure Subgroup

Revenue and Quantity Measures

Showing 10 out of 10 measures

Dimension Levels

3 Levels Selected

Time Granularity

1 Level Selected

Show all Periods

Display Settings

Row Settings

Expand All RowsCollapse All Rows

Column Settings

Reset Column WidthFreeze columns

Measures / Dimensions x Time	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul
Sales Agreement Quantity	800	720	800	825	800	780	800
MagnaDrive - Michigan Plant	800	720	800	825	800	780	800
Transmission Assembly	400	400	400	425	400	380	400
TRN 750 - A	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
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TRN 750 - C	95	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - D	65	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - E	80	80	80	80	80	60	80
Chassis Components	400	320	400	400	400	400	400
Sales Agreement Revenue	\$80,000	\$70,500	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$78,800
Opportunity Quantity	1,200	1,200	1,230	1,140	1,200	1,200	1,200
Opportunity Revenue	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$112,000	\$120,000	\$120,000
Order Quantity	950	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Contextual slide-out panel that doesn't interrupt workflow. Clean form controls with proper spacing and grouping.

✓ UX Advantage: Non-Modal Panels

Unlike SAP and Oracle which use modal dialogs that block the main interface, our slide-out panels allow users to see context while making changes. This is consistent with modern SaaS patterns used by Pigment and Notion.

4. Filters Panel

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

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Search in Grid..

Filters

All filter criteria are combined using AND logic

Filter by Category

Equals All

Filter by Products

Equals All

Filter by Time

Equals Jan 26 to Dec 26

Add FilterRemove All

Measures / Dimensions x Time	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul
Sales Agreement Quantity	800	720	800	825	800	780	800
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Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
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Dedicated filtering panel with product and time filter blocks. Each filter shows a summary and opens a multi-select popover on edit.

UX Advantages:

- **Multi-select Popovers:** Modern interaction pattern vs. complex dialogs
- **Visual Summary:** Users can see active filters at a glance
- **Non-blocking:** Filters don't interrupt grid workflow

5. Cell Details & History Panel

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

Search in Grid..

Measures / Dimensions x Time

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TRN 750 - D	65	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - E	80	80	80	80	80	60	80	80	90	80
Chassis Components	400	320	400	400	400	400	400	340	400	400
Sales Agreement Revenue	\$80,000	\$70,500	\$80,000	\$79,965	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$78,800	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000
Opportunity Quantity	1,200	1,200	1,230	1,140	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200
Opportunity Revenue	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$112,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$115,000	\$120,000	\$120,000
Order Quantity	950	950	950	935	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$93,500	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Years Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Cell History

Sales Agreement Quantity - Apr 2026 - TRN 750 - B

John Carter Jan 30, 2026, 12:16 PM
Decreased from 120 to 80 (-40)

John Carter Jan 30, 2026, 12:16 PM
Increased from 105 to 120 (+15)

John Carter Jan 29, 2026, 12:16 PM
Increased from 80 to 105 (+25) Hide note
TRN 750 - B showing strong performance in Q2, adjusted forecast upward

Add a comment... Post

Comments

Enter a comment

Attach File Post

Salesforce-inspired activity timeline showing detailed edit history. Displays user name, timestamp, value changes (e.g., "Decreased from 120 to 80 (-40)"), and adjustment notes. History entries are chronologically ordered with expandable notes. Users can add comments directly to specific history entries or post general comments.

✓ Activity Timeline Features:

- **Vertical Connector Line:** Between events, like Salesforce
- **User Avatars:** Initials-based avatars with consistent styling
- **Threaded Discussions:** Reply directly to specific edits
- **Expand/Collapse:** Detailed info hidden until needed
- **Value Changes:** Clear before/after with delta calculation

Competitive Advantage: SAP and Oracle only support attachments or basic notes. Our threaded timeline matches Pigment's collaboration features while leveraging Salesforce's familiar pattern.

6. Search with Real-time Highlighting

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

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Search in Grid..

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Order Quantity	950	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Edit Information

History Bulk Edit

Complete cell edit history
Select cells in the grid to view their specific history

Transmission Assembly - Feb 2026 - Sales A...
John Carter Jan 29, 2026, 12:01 PM
Decreased from \$40,000 to \$35,000 (-\$5,000)
Hide note
Adjusted downward due to supply chain delays affecting transmission assembly

TRN 750 - B - Apr 2026 - Sales Agreement Q...
John Carter Jan 29, 2026, 12:01 PM
Increased from 80 to 105 (+25) See note

Chassis Product 1 - Jun 2026 - Sales Agree...
John Carter Jan 29, 2026, 12:01 PM
Increased from 120 to 145 (+25) See note

Comments
Enter a general comment

Attach File Post

Instant search filtering across hierarchies with visual highlighting of matched text. Columns automatically filter to show only relevant time periods.

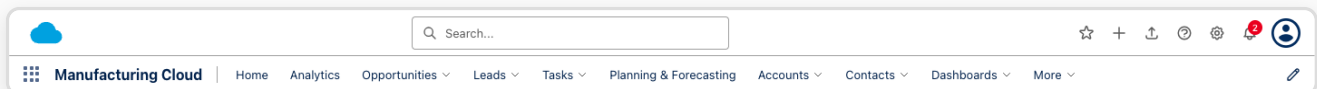
Our Solution

- Real-time filtering as you type
- Yellow highlighting on matched text
- Hierarchical awareness (shows parents of matching children)
- Column filtering (time periods)
- No "Apply" button needed

Anaplan / SAP / Oracle

- Basic search with filter buttons
- No real-time highlighting
- Often requires clicking "Apply" button
- Separate search and filter interfaces
- Less intuitive workflow

7. Header Design



Two-row header matching Salesforce Lightning template with cloud logo, search bar, navigation tabs, and user icons.

✓ Salesforce Lightning Design System

Our header follows Salesforce Lightning Design System patterns, providing instant familiarity for millions of Salesforce users. This reduces learning curve and increases adoption speed compared to competitors with proprietary interfaces.

8. Hierarchical Expansion & Cell Selection

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

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Search in Grid..

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Order Quantity	950	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Edit Information

History Bulk Edit

Complete cell edit history

Select cells in the grid to view their specific history

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John Carter Jan 29, 2026, 12:01 PM
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Hide note
Adjusted downward due to supply chain delays affecting transmission assembly

TRN 750 - B - Apr 2026 - Sales Agreement Q...
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Increased from 80 to 105 (+25) Hide note
TRN 750 - B showing strong performance in Q2, adjusted forecast upward

Comments

Enter a general comment

Attach File Post

Expand/collapse functionality with visual indicators. Selected cells show clear focus state.

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Search in Grid..

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Order Quantity	950	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

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Comments

Enter a general comment

Attach File Post

Context menu with right-click actions including "View Edit History" option for single cell selection.

UX Advantages:

- **Visual Hierarchy:** Clear parent-child relationships
- **Expand/Collapse:** Users control detail level
- **Cell Selection:** Clear focus states and multi-select support
- **Context Menu:** Right-click access to actions

9. Bulk Update & Mass Operations

Search...

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

Search in Grid..

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Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
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Select multiple cells using Shift+Click or Cmd/Ctrl+Click. Selected cells are highlighted with clear visual indicators.

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Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
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Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Right-click context menu shows "Bulk Edit" option when multiple cells are selected, providing quick access to mass update functionality.

Manufacturing Cloud

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Opportunity Revenue	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$112,000	\$120,000	\$120,000
Order Quantity	950	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Edit Information

Cell History

Cell Edit

No cell edit history available for this cell. Edit the value or add a note to see the changes logged here.

Comments

Enter a comment

Attach File

Post

Cell Details & Updates panel automatically switches to "Bulk Edit" tab when multiple cells are selected, showing update rules and value input.

Manufacturing Cloud | Home Analytics Opportunities Leads Tasks Planning & Forecasting Accounts Contacts Dashboards More

Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

Search in Grid..

Measures / Dimensions x Time

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct
Sales Agreement Quantity	800	720	800	800	800	780	800	740	810	815
MagnaDrive - Michigan Plant	800	720	800	800	800	780	800	740	810	815
Transmission Assembly	400	400	400	400	400	380	400	400	410	415
TRN 750 - A	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - B	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - C	95	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	95
TRN 750 - D	65	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - E	80	80	80	80	80	60	80	80	90	80
Chassis Components	400	320	400	400	400	400	400	340	400	400
Sales Agreement Revenue	\$80,000	\$70,500	\$80,000	\$79,965	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$78,800	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000
Opportunity Quantity	1,200	1,200	1,230	1,140	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200
Opportunity Revenue	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$112,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$115,000	\$120,000	\$120,000
Order Quantity	950	950	950	935	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$93,500	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Edit Information

History Bulk Edit

Select Cells

Automatically

Cell Selection Criteria

+ Add Condition + Add Group

Select Action

Bulk Edit

Rule

Increase

Value

20%

Bulk Adjustment Note

Enter adjustment note (optional)

Cancel Update

Advanced form-based bulk edit with criteria-based cell selection. Users can select cells "Automatically" using conditions and groups, or "Manually" by clicking. Form includes: Select Action (Bulk Edit), Rule (Increase/Decrease/Set to/Multiply/Divide), Value input (supports percentages like "20%"), and optional Bulk Adjustment Note. This provides powerful, Excel-like bulk operations with Salesforce-native UI patterns.

Manufacturing Cloud | Home Analytics Opportunities Leads Tasks Planning & Forecasting Accounts Contacts Dashboards More

Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

Search in Grid..

Measures / Dimensions x Time

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul
Sales Agreement Quantity	800	720	800	825	800	780	800
MagnaDrive - Michigan Plant	800	720	800	825	800	780	800
Transmission Assembly	400	400	400	425	400	380	400
TRN 750 - A	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - B	80	80	80	105	80	80	80
TRN 750 - C	95	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - D	65	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - E	80	80	80	80	80	60	80
Chassis Components	400	320	400	400	400	400	400
Sales Agreement Revenue	\$80,000	\$70,500	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$78,800
Opportunity Quantity	1,200	1,200	1,230	1,140	1,200	1,200	1,200
Opportunity Revenue	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$112,000	\$120,000	\$120,000
Order Quantity	950	950	950	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000
Last Year Order Quantity	750	750	750	750	750	750	750
Last Year Order Revenue	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000	\$75,000

Edit Information

Cell History Edit Cell

No cell edit history available for this cell. Edit the value or add a note to see the changes logged here.

Comments

Enter a comment

Attach File Post

Google Sheets-like fill handle (small dot) at bottom-right corner of selected cell for drag-based bulk selection across ranges.

Manufacturing Cloud Planning & Forecasting FY26 - Grid View

Measures / Dimensions x Time

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct
Sales Agreement Quantity	800	720	+20.00% 960	+20.00% 990	+20.00% 960	+20.00% 936	800	740	810	815
MagnaDrive - Michigan Plant	800	720	+20.00% 960	+20.00% 990	+20.00% 960	+20.00% 936	800	740	810	815
Transmission Assembly	400	400	+20.00% 480	+20.00% 510	+20.00% 480	+20.00% 456	400	400	410	415
TRN 750 - A	80	80	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - B	80	80	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - C	95	80	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	80	80	80	95
TRN 750 - D	65	80	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - E	80	80	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 96	+20.00% 72	80	80	+20.00% 90	80
Chassis Components	400	320	+20.00% 480	+20.00% 480	+20.00% 480	+20.00% 480	400	340	400	400
Sales Agreement Revenue	\$80,000	\$70,500	+20.00% \$96,000	+20.00% \$96,000	+20.00% \$96,000	+20.00% \$96,000	\$78,800	\$80,000	\$80,000	\$80,000
Opportunity Quantity	1,200	1,200	1,230	1,140	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200	1,200
Opportunity Revenue	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$112,000	\$120,000	\$120,000	\$115,000	\$120,000	\$120,000
Order Quantity	950	950	+1.05% 960	+4.21% 990	+1.05% 960	-1.47% 936	950	950	950	950
Order Revenue	\$95,000	\$95,000	+1.05% \$96,000	+4.21% \$99,000	+1.05% \$96,000	-1.47% \$93,600	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000	\$95,000

6 measures impacted Show Only Impacted Measures

Save Changes

Edit Information

Select Cells: Manually

Select Action: Bulk Edit

Rule: Increase

Value: 20%

Bulk Adjustment Note: Enter adjustment note (optional)

Cancel Update

Complete bulk edit workflow: Grid showing selected cells with percentage changes (e.g., "+20.00%"), Bulk Edit panel open with Increase rule set to "20%", and visual indicators (arrows) showing which cells were updated. The interface shows real-time feedback with percentage changes displayed directly in cells.

Our Solution

- **Multiple Selection Methods:** Shift+Click, Cmd/Ctrl+Click, Fill Handle drag
- **Context Menu Access:** Right-click "Bulk Edit" option
- **Panel Integration:** Automatic switch to Bulk Edit tab
- **Flexible Rules:** Increase, Decrease, Set to, Multiply, Divide
- **Percentage Support:** "10%" increases by 10%
- **Bulk Notes:** Single note applies to all updated cells
- **Visual Feedback:** Clear selection indicators
- **Order Preservation:** Updates maintain selection order
- **Criteria-Based Selection:** "Automatically" select cells using conditions and groups
- **Form-Based Interface:** Clean form layout with dropdowns and input fields

Competitors

- **Pigment:** ✓ Similar bulk operations, modern UI
- **Anaplan:** ✓ Bulk update available, complex interface
- **SAP:** ✗ Limited bulk operations, form-based
- **Oracle:** ✗ Basic bulk edit, requires multiple steps
- **Workday:** ✓ Bulk update available, simpler rules

Key Differentiator: Our fill handle drag selection and percentage-based updates provide Excel-like familiarity while maintaining Salesforce-native integration.

UX Advantages:

- **Familiar Patterns:** Fill handle and selection methods match Excel/Google Sheets expectations
- **Multiple Access Points:** Context menu, panel tab, and keyboard shortcuts provide flexibility
- **Smart Defaults:** Panel automatically switches to appropriate tab based on selection
- **Percentage Calculations:** Natural language like "10%" is more intuitive than manual calculations
- **Bulk Documentation:** Single note applies to all cells, reducing repetitive data entry
- **Visual Clarity:** Selected cells clearly highlighted, making it easy to verify selection before update
- **Real-time Feedback:** Percentage changes displayed directly in cells (e.g., "+20.00%") showing exactly what changed
- **Visual Indicators:** Arrow icons (orange up, blue down) provide immediate visual feedback on cell changes
- **Impacted Measures Tracking:** Bottom bar shows "X measures impacted" helping users understand scope of changes

Detailed Bulk Edit Function Comparison

Feature	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle	Workday
Selection Methods	Shift+Click, Cmd/Ctrl+Click, Fill Handle	Multiple methods	Shift+Click, limited	Form-based selection	Form-based selection	Shift+Click

Update Rules	5 rules: Increase, Decrease, Set to, Multiply, Divide	Comprehensive rules	Advanced formulas	Basic: Set to, Add	Basic: Set to, Add	Standard rules
Percentage Support	✓ Natural syntax "20%"	✓ Yes	Formula- based	✗ Manual calculation	✗ Manual calculation	✓ Limited
Visual Feedback in Cells	✓ Percentage shown in cell	✓ Visual indicators	Color coding	✗ No inline display	✗ No inline display	Badge indicators
Change Indicators	✓ Arrow icons (up/down)	✓ Dot indicators	Color changes	✗ None	✗ None	Status badges
Bulk Notes	✓ Single note for all cells	✓ Yes	Per-cell notes	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	Limited
Impact Preview	✓ "X measures impacted"	✓ Preview before apply	Summary view	✗ No preview	✗ No preview	Basic summary
Context Menu Access	✓ Right-click "Bulk Edit"	✓ Context menu	Toolbar button	✗ Menu only	✗ Menu only	Toolbar
Panel Integration	✓ Auto-switch to Bulk Edit tab	✓ Contextual panel	Separate dialog	✗ Modal dialog	✗ Modal dialog	Side panel
Fill Handle Selection	✓ Google Sheets-like drag	✓ Yes	✗ No	✗ No	✗ No	✗ No

Key Competitive Advantages:

- Percentage Display in Cells:** Unlike SAP and Oracle which require users to calculate percentages manually, our solution displays percentage changes directly in cells (e.g., "+20.00% 960"), making it immediately clear what changed and by how much.
- Visual Arrow Indicators:** Orange up arrows and blue down arrows provide instant visual feedback on which cells increased or decreased, without requiring users to compare values.
- Fill Handle Drag Selection:** Excel/Google Sheets-like fill handle allows users to quickly select ranges by dragging, a feature missing in Anaplan, SAP, Oracle, and Workday.
- Natural Percentage Syntax:** Users can simply type "20%" instead of calculating 1.2x multiplier, making bulk updates more intuitive than Anaplan's formula-based approach.

5. **Impacted Measures Tracking:** Bottom bar shows "X measures impacted" helping users understand the scope of their bulk changes before saving.

6. **Non-Modal Panel:** Unlike SAP and Oracle's modal dialogs that block the grid, our slide-out panel allows users to see both the form and the grid simultaneously.

Detailed UX Comparison

Feature-by-Feature UX Analysis

UX Aspect	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle	Workday
Design System	Salesforce Lightning	Modern Custom	Proprietary	Fiori (Legacy)	Oracle Redwood	Workday Canvas
Visual Aesthetics	★★★★☆	★★★★★	★★★★☆	★★☆☆☆	★★☆☆☆	★★★★☆
Grid Flexibility	3 Layout Options	Flexible Views	Custom Modules	Fixed Layouts	Fixed Layouts	Limited Options
Search Experience	Real-time + Highlight	Smart Search	Basic Search	Limited	Limited	Basic Search
Inline Editing	Seamless	Seamless	Modal-based	Form-based	Form-based	Mixed
Cell Comments	Threaded + Timeline	Threaded	Basic Notes	Attachments Only	Basic Notes	Comments
Button/Icon Design	Modern Button Groups	Clean & Modern	Functional	Dated	Dated	Clean
Panel/Sidebar UX	Slide-out Panels	Contextual Panels	Modal Windows	Separate Pages	Separate Pages	Side Panels
Hierarchy Navigation	Expand/Collapse + Popover	Drill-down	Drill-down	Tree Structure	Tree Structure	Drill-down
Filter Experience	Multi-select Popovers	Smart Filters	Filter Panels	Complex Dialogs	Complex Dialogs	Filter Bar
Learning Curve	Hours	Hours	Days	Weeks	Weeks	Hours-Days
Mobile Responsiveness	Responsive Design	Responsive	Limited	Desktop Only	Desktop Only	Mobile App
Undo/Redo	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✗ No	Limited	Partial

Copy/Paste Multiple Cells	Roadmap	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Bulk Update Operations	Fill Handle + Rules	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Limited	Basic	✓ Yes
Bulk Update Rules	5 Rules + % Support	Flexible	Comprehensive	Basic	Basic	Standard
Fill Handle Selection	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Limited	✗ No	✗ No	Partial
Visual Change Indicators	Dog-ear + Arrows	Dot Indicator	Color Coding	None	Color Coding	Badge
Typography	Excellent	Excellent	Good	Average	Average	Good
Spacing/Layout	Well-spaced	Generous	Dense	Cramped	Dense	Balanced
Animations	Basic	Smooth	Minimal	None	Minimal	Basic
Dark Mode	Not Available	✓ Yes	Not Available	Not Available	Not Available	Limited
Keyboard Shortcuts	Basic	Comprehensive	Comprehensive	Limited	Limited	Basic

Our Solution: UX Strengths

See screenshots above for visual examples of each strength.

Salesforce Lightning Design System

Native integration with Salesforce Lightning Design System provides familiar experience for millions of existing Salesforce users, dramatically reducing learning curve.

✓ **Advantage: Zero learning curve for SF users**

See: Header Design screenshot

Three Grid Layouts

Flexible layout options (Measures×Time, Dimensions×Time, Time×Dimensions) allow users to choose the view that best fits their workflow.

✓ **Advantage: More flexible than SAP/Oracle fixed layouts**

See: Full Grid View screenshot (latest)

Real-time Search with Highlighting

Instant filtering across hierarchies with visual match highlighting. Columns automatically filter to show only relevant time periods.

✓ **Advantage: Better than Anaplan/SAP/Oracle basic search**

See: Search Highlighting screenshot

Salesforce-style Activity Timeline

Edit history with threaded discussions, consistent with Salesforce record pages. Users feel at home in familiar interface patterns.

✓ **Advantage: Unique to Salesforce ecosystem**

See: Cell Details Panel screenshot

Inline Adjustment Notes

Add context to cell changes without leaving the grid. Notes appear in edit history timeline with full threading support.

✓ **Advantage: Better than SAP/Oracle attachment-only approach**

See: Cell Details Panel screenshot

Modern Toolbar Design

Clean button groups with active state indicators. Pill-shaped containers with consistent iconography.

✓ **Advantage: More modern than legacy toolbar designs**

See: Button Group Toolbar screenshot

Slide-out Panels

Non-modal slide-out panels for settings, filters, and cell details. Users maintain context while making

Fast Learning Curve

Users can be productive within hours, compared to weeks for SAP and Oracle implementations.

changes.

✓ **Advantage: Better than SAP/Oracle modal dialogs**

See: Settings Panel & Filters Panel screenshots

✓ **Advantage: Rapid time-to-value**

See: All screenshots demonstrate intuitive design

Competitor UX Analysis

Pigment - The UX Benchmark (9.0/10)

Why Pigment Leads: Founded in 2019 with UX-first philosophy, specifically designed to disrupt legacy planning tools. Interface takes inspiration from modern tools like Notion and Figma.

UX Strengths

- Pixel-perfect modern design with smooth animations
- Real-time collaboration (like Google Docs)
- Intuitive drag-and-drop modeling
- Dark mode support
- Comprehensive keyboard shortcuts for power users
- Generous spacing and clean typography

Where We Can Compete

- **Salesforce-native integration:** We win - Pigment requires connectors
- **Manufacturing-specific workflows:** Our domain expertise
- **Familiar UI for SF users:** Lower learning curve for SF ecosystem

Key Insight: Pigment sets the standard for modern planning UX. We should aspire to match their polish while leveraging our Salesforce integration advantage.

Anaplan - Enterprise Standard (6.9/10)

Mature but Aging Interface: Anaplan has been around since 2006 and their interface shows its age. While functional, it prioritizes power over polish.

UX Strengths

- Powerful modeling interface
- Comprehensive dashboards

- Good keyboard navigation
- Robust export options

UX Weaknesses

- Cluttered interface
- Steep learning curve
- Modal-heavy interactions
- Dated visual design
- Complex navigation structure

Key Insight: Anaplan prioritizes functionality over UX. We can win on ease of use and modern design while matching their core capabilities.

SAP IBP & Analytics Cloud (4.9/10)

Enterprise Complexity: SAP's planning tools inherit the complexity of the broader SAP ecosystem. While powerful, the UX is designed for trained administrators rather than business users.

UX Strengths

- Fiori design system (improving)
- Deep ERP integration
- Comprehensive functionality

UX Weaknesses

- Very steep learning curve (weeks of training)
- Complex multi-screen workflows
- Overwhelming for new users
- Inconsistent UI patterns
- Heavy, slow-loading interfaces
- Desktop-only experience

Key Insight: SAP prioritizes power at the cost of usability. We can win decisively on UX while targeting mid-market customers who don't need SAP's full complexity.

Oracle EPM Cloud (5.2/10)

Legacy Meets Cloud: Oracle's EPM Cloud modernizes their Hyperion legacy but still carries enterprise complexity. The Redwood design system is improving things gradually.

UX Strengths

- Redwood design (newer, cleaner)
- Strong financial close UX
- Good reporting interfaces

UX Weaknesses

- Complex setup screens
- Multiple products, inconsistent UX
- Heavy admin interfaces
- Slow cloud performance
- Desktop-only experience

Key Insight: Oracle is improving but still carries legacy weight. We can win on modern UX and faster implementation.

Workday Adaptive Planning (7.5/10)

User-Friendly Enterprise: Workday has invested heavily in UX, resulting in a clean, intuitive interface that balances power with usability.

UX Strengths

- Clean, modern interface
- Good mobile app
- Intuitive navigation
- Strong Workday integration

UX Weaknesses

- Limited grid flexibility
- Less advanced search capabilities
- Basic collaboration features

Key Insight: Workday is a strong UX competitor, but they focus on Workday ecosystem. We can compete on Salesforce integration and manufacturing-specific features.

Visual Design Comparison

Design Aspect	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle	Workday
Design System	Salesforce Lightning	Custom Modern	Proprietary	SAP Fiori	Oracle Redwood	Workday Canvas
Typography	Excellent	Excellent	Good	Average	Average	Good
Color Palette	Modern Blue (#0176d3)	Vibrant Custom	Muted Corporate	Corporate Blue	Corporate Red	Clean Neutral
Iconography	Consistent	Custom	Mixed	Fiori Icons	Mixed	Consistent
Spacing/Layout	Well-spaced	Generous	Dense	Cramped	Dense	Balanced
Animations	Basic	Smooth	Minimal	None	Minimal	Basic
Dark Mode	Not Available	✓ Yes	Not Available	Not Available	Not Available	Limited

Interaction Patterns Comparison

Grid Editing Experience

Capability	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle	Workday
Inline cell editing	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Partial	Partial	✓ Yes
Tab/Arrow navigation	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Limited	Limited	✓ Yes
Undo/Redo	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✗ No	Limited	Partial
Copy/Paste multiple cells	Roadmap	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Cell-level comments	Threaded	Threaded	Basic	Attachments	Notes	Comments
Visual change indicator	Dog-ear + Arrows	Dot	Color	None	Color	Badge
Bulk operations	Mass Update	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Limited

Navigation & Layout

Capability	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle	Workday
Multiple grid layouts	3 Options	Flexible	Custom	Limited	Limited	Limited
Breadcrumb navigation	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Partial	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Partial
Slide-out panels	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Modals	Pages	Pages	Side Panels
Real-time search	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Basic	No	No	Basic
Search highlighting	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	No	No	No	No
Frozen headers	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes

UX Improvement Recommendations

Where We Excel

- **Salesforce Integration:** Native Lightning Design System - familiar to millions of SF users
- **Search Experience:** Real-time filtering with highlighting - better than Anaplan, SAP, Oracle
- **Collaboration UX:** Salesforce-style timeline with threaded discussions
- **Panel Design:** Modern slide-out panels vs. legacy modal dialogs
- **Button Group Toolbar:** Clean, modern interaction pattern
- **Learning Curve:** Much faster adoption than enterprise alternatives

Where We Can Improve

High Priority (0-3 Months)



Smooth Animations

Add smooth transitions like Pigment: expand/collapse animations, panel slide transitions, loading skeletons.

Current: Basic animations

Target: Smooth, polished transitions



Keyboard Shortcuts

Comprehensive keyboard shortcuts for power users: navigation, editing, bulk operations.

Current: Basic shortcuts

Target: Full keyboard navigation



Multi-cell Operations

Copy/paste across cell ranges, fill handle drag (already implemented), bulk formatting.

Current: Roadmap item

Target: Full Excel-like operations



Visual Polish

Micro-interactions, hover states, loading skeletons, smooth transitions between states.

Current: Functional but basic

Target: Polished, delightful interactions

Medium Priority (3-6 Months)

- **Dark Mode:** Pigment offers this, we don't yet. High user demand feature.
- **Mobile/Responsive:** Better tablet and mobile experience for plan review and approval.
- **Accessibility:** Enhanced keyboard navigation, screen reader support, ARIA labels.
- **Performance:** Optimize for large datasets, virtual scrolling, lazy loading.

Long-term Vision (6-12 Months)

- **AI-Powered UX:** Smart suggestions, auto-complete, predictive text in notes
- **Customizable Themes:** User-selectable color schemes and layouts
- **Advanced Visualizations:** Inline charts, sparklines, trend indicators
- **Gesture Support:** Touch gestures for tablet users

Final UX Ranking

Rank	Solution	Score	Best For	Key Differentiator
1	Pigment	9.0/10	Modern companies prioritizing UX	Pixel-perfect design, smooth animations
2	Our Solution	8.3/10	Salesforce ecosystem users	Native SF integration, familiar UX
3	Workday Adaptive	7.5/10	Workday customers	Clean interface, good mobile app
4	Anaplan	6.9/10	Power users needing flexibility	Powerful modeling, comprehensive features
5	Oracle EPM	5.2/10	Oracle ecosystem enterprises	Redwood design improving
6	SAP IBP	4.9/10	SAP-centric organizations	Deep ERP integration

Bottom Line

Our solution delivers strong UX that significantly outperforms legacy enterprise tools (SAP, Oracle, Anaplan) while approaching—but not yet matching—the UX excellence of Pigment. Our key differentiator is native Salesforce integration, which provides a familiar experience for the millions of users already in the Salesforce ecosystem.

With focused improvements in animations, keyboard shortcuts, and mobile responsiveness, we can further close the gap with Pigment and establish ourselves as the leading planning tool for Salesforce Manufacturing Cloud customers.